Volunteer Policy

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Volunteer Policy

Policy Statement

At [INSERT CARE HOME NAME], we recognise the valuable contribution volunteers make to enriching the lives of our residents. Volunteers bring additional skills, companionship, and community engagement to our service. We are committed to ensuring volunteers are welcomed, supported, and integrated into the home while maintaining clear boundaries and safeguarding the welfare of residents. We aim to:

- Provide safe and meaningful opportunities for volunteers
- Ensure volunteers are recruited, trained, and supported appropriately
- Protect residents, staff, and volunteers through clear expectations and safeguarding measures
- Promote inclusion, respect, and positive relationships

Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to:

- Set out the framework for recruiting, training, and supporting volunteers
- Define the roles and responsibilities of volunteers and staff
- Ensure compliance with safeguarding, health and safety, and regulatory standards
- Provide clarity on boundaries between staff duties and volunteer roles

Scope

This policy applies to:

- All volunteers working within [INSERT CARE HOME NAME]
- Staff who supervise, support, or work alongside volunteers
- Residents and families who engage with volunteers

Roles and Responsibilities

Registered Manager:

- Oversees the volunteer programme and ensures compliance with legal and regulatory requirements
- Ensures volunteers are recruited safely and supported appropriately
- Provides supervision and ensures volunteers have a named contact person

Staff:

- Support and work alongside volunteers in a respectful and inclusive manner
- Do not delegate professional responsibilities or regulated care tasks to volunteers
- Report concerns about volunteer conduct or safeguarding issues

Volunteers:

- Must follow the care home's policies, procedures, and code of conduct
- Respect the confidentiality, privacy, and dignity of residents
- Work under supervision and within agreed role boundaries
- Report concerns, incidents, or safeguarding issues immediately

Recruitment and Selection

- Volunteers must complete an application process, including an interview or informal discussion.
- References will be obtained, and DBS checks will be carried out where roles involve direct contact with residents.
- Volunteers must be deemed suitable for their role, taking into account skills, experience, and motivation.
- The home reserves the right to decline or end volunteer arrangements if risks or concerns arise.

Induction, Training, and Supervision

- All volunteers will receive an induction covering safeguarding, confidentiality, infection control, fire safety, and health and safety.
- Volunteers will receive training appropriate to their role (e.g., dementia awareness, communication skills).
- Each volunteer will have a named supervisor for guidance and support.
- Ongoing supervision and review will ensure volunteers feel supported and effective.

Volunteer Roles and Boundaries

- Volunteers may support with activities, companionship, outings, mealtime assistance (non-feeding), and community events.
- Volunteers may not undertake personal care, administer medication, handle residents' finances, or perform regulated healthcare tasks.
- Volunteers must always act under supervision and within agreed role descriptions.

Safeguarding and Confidentiality

- Volunteers must follow the Safeguarding Adults Policy and report any concerns immediately.
- Volunteers must sign a Confidentiality Agreement before starting.
- Volunteers must not share personal information about residents or staff outside the care home.

Expenses

- Reasonable travel or out-of-pocket expenses may be reimbursed with prior agreement and receipts.
- Volunteers are not paid and do not replace paid staff roles.

Health and Safety

- Volunteers must comply with health and safety policies, including infection prevention and fire safety procedures.
- Risk assessments will be carried out for volunteer activities.
- Volunteers must report accidents, injuries, or hazards immediately.

Recognition and Support

- Volunteers will be thanked and recognised for their contributions.
- Regular feedback opportunities will be provided.
- Volunteers may be invited to team events, meetings, or training sessions.

Monitoring and Review

- The Registered Manager will monitor the effectiveness of the volunteer programme.
- Feedback from residents, staff, and volunteers will inform improvements.
- This policy will be reviewed annually or sooner if required.

References

- Health and Social Care Act 2008 (Regulated Activities) Regulations 2014
- Care Quality Commission (CQC) Fundamental Standards
- Safeguarding Vulnerable Groups Act 2006
- Health and Safety at Work Act 1974
- Data Protection Act 2018 / UK GDPR

Related Policies

- Safeguarding Adults Policy
- Confidentiality / GDPR Policy
- Health and Safety Policy
- Recruitment Policy
- Equality, Diversity, and Inclusion Policy

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